

NTANDOMODS

TILL OPERATING PROGRAMME

2-Week Short Course

Covering: Cash Handling / EcoCash / Bank Transfers / Card Swipe

Zimbabwe's #1 Practical Skills Programme

No O-Level Required | NtandoMods Certificate Awarded

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Introduction

Welcome to the NtandoMods Till Operating Programme. This 2-week short course is designed to give you the practical skills needed to work confidently at a retail till in Zimbabwe. You do not need any qualifications to start this course. All you need is the willingness to learn and work hard.

By the end of this course, you will be able to handle customer payments using cash, EcoCash mobile money, bank transfers, and card swipe machines. You will also understand how to open and close a till, balance your float, and deal with common problems that arise at the point of sale.

Who This Course Is For

- School leavers looking for their first job in retail
- Unemployed youth wanting practical, job-ready skills
- Anyone working in a shop who wants to improve their till skills
- Entrepreneurs who run their own small businesses

What You Will Need

- A pen and notebook for taking notes
- Willingness to practise every day

- This course book

Course Duration

This course runs over 2 weeks (10 working days). Each day covers specific topics with practical exercises.

Week	Days	Topics Covered
Week 1	Days 1-5	Till basics, cash handling, float management
Week 2	Days 6-10	EcoCash, bank transfers, card swipe, assessments

WEEK 1 - Till Basics and Cash Handling

Day 1: Understanding the Till and Your Workspace

What is a Till?

A till (also called a cash register or point of sale machine) is the equipment used to process customer payments in a shop. It keeps a record of every sale made and stores the cash safely.

Parts of a Till

- Cash drawer - where coins and notes are stored
- Receipt printer - prints receipts for customers
- Barcode scanner - reads product codes
- Display screen - shows the operator and customer the sale total
- Keypad / keyboard - used to enter amounts and commands
- Card swipe terminal - connected to the till for card payments

Your Responsibilities as a Till Operator

1. Always greet customers politely
2. Scan or enter every item correctly
3. Count cash carefully before giving change

4. Issue a receipt for every transaction
5. Never leave the till unattended
6. Report any problems to your supervisor immediately

Day 1 Practical Exercise

Familiarise yourself with the till at your training station. Identify each part listed above. Write down what each button or section of the till does.

Day 2: Opening the Till and Float Management

What is a Float?

A float is the starting amount of cash that is placed in the till at the beginning of each working day. The float is used to give change to customers. It is NOT part of the day's takings — it must be returned at the end of the day.

Standard Float in Zimbabwe

A typical float in a Zimbabwean retail shop includes small denominations of USD and ZiG coins and notes so that change can be given easily.

Denomination	Quantity	Value
\$1 USD notes	5	\$5.00
\$0.50 USD coins	10	\$5.00
\$0.25 USD coins	10	\$2.50
\$0.10 USD coins	20	\$2.00
\$0.05 USD coins	10	\$0.50
TOTAL FLOAT		\$15.00

Steps to Open the Till

1. Receive the float from your supervisor and count it in front of them
2. Both you and your supervisor sign the float sheet
3. Place each denomination in the correct section of the cash drawer
4. Lock the cash drawer
5. Log in to the till system with your operator code

6. Print a Z-read or opening report if required
7. You are now ready to serve customers

Day 2 Practical Exercise

Practice counting out a float of \$15.00 USD using mixed denominations. Count it three times to make sure it is correct. Then complete the float sheet provided by your trainer.

Day 3: Cash Handling and Giving Change

Receiving Cash from a Customer

When a customer pays with cash, follow these steps every single time:

1. Tell the customer the total amount due
2. Receive the cash from the customer
3. Place the cash on TOP of the cash drawer — do NOT put it inside yet
4. Count the cash to confirm the amount received
5. Enter the amount received into the till
6. The till will calculate and display the change amount
7. Count out the change from the drawer
8. Place the received cash into the drawer and close it
9. Hand the change and receipt to the customer

IMPORTANT: Always place received cash on top of the drawer until change is given. This prevents disputes about what note the customer gave you.

Counting Change - The Count-Up Method

The safest way to give change is to count up from the sale amount to the amount given. This is called the count-up method.

Example: Customer's total is \$7.50. They give you \$10.00.

- You owe them \$2.50 change

- Count up: '\$7.50... \$8.00 (give 50c)... \$9.00 (give \$1)... \$10.00 (give \$1)'
- Hand over the change while counting aloud

Handling Counterfeit Notes

Counterfeit (fake) notes are a serious problem in Zimbabwe. You must check every large note.

- Feel the note - genuine notes have a distinct texture
- Hold it up to the light - look for the watermark and security thread
- Use a counterfeit detection pen if available
- If unsure, call your supervisor immediately - never accuse the customer directly
- Never accept a note you are not sure about

Day 3 Practical Exercise

Complete the change-giving exercises below using the count-up method:

Sale Total	Amount Given	Change Due
\$3.75	\$5.00	\$1.25
\$12.40	\$20.00	\$7.60
\$0.90	\$1.00	\$0.10
\$8.15	\$10.00	\$1.85
\$25.60	\$30.00	\$4.40

Day 4: Processing Sales and Voids

Processing a Normal Sale

1. Greet the customer
2. Scan each item using the barcode scanner or enter the price manually
3. Check that each item scanned correctly on the display
4. Announce the total to the customer
5. Process the payment (cash, EcoCash, card, or bank transfer)

6. Print the receipt and hand it to the customer
7. Thank the customer

What is a Void?

A void cancels a transaction or removes an item that was scanned incorrectly. You should use a void when:

- You scanned an item twice by mistake
- The customer changed their mind about an item
- You entered the wrong price

How to Void an Item

1. Do NOT process the payment yet
2. Find the void or delete button on your till
3. Select the item to be removed
4. Enter your supervisor override code if required
5. Confirm that the item has been removed from the total

Note: You should never void a completed transaction without supervisor approval. All voids are recorded by the system.

Refunds

A refund returns money to a customer for goods they are returning. Refunds must always be approved by a supervisor. Never process a refund on your own authority.

1. Customer presents goods and receipt
2. Call your supervisor to authorise the refund
3. Process the refund through the till using the refund function
4. Get the customer to sign the refund slip
5. Return the money in the same method it was paid

Day 5: Closing the Till and Cash-Up

End-of-Day Procedures

At the end of every shift, the till must be properly closed and all cash must be counted and reconciled. This process is called cashing up.

Steps to Close the Till

1. Stop serving customers
2. Print the X-read or Z-read report from the till (this shows total sales for the day)
3. Remove all cash from the drawer
4. Count all notes and coins carefully
5. Separate the float from the day's takings
6. Complete the cash-up sheet with the exact amounts
7. Compare your cash total to the till report total
8. Report any discrepancy to your supervisor immediately
9. Place the day's takings in the cash bag and seal it
10. Hand the bag and cash-up sheet to your supervisor

Understanding Till Discrepancies

A discrepancy is when the cash in the drawer does not match the amount the till system says should be there.

Type	Meaning	What to Do
Over	More cash than expected	Report to supervisor, do not keep the extra
Short	Less cash than expected	Report to supervisor, recount carefully first
Balanced	Cash matches the till report	Complete paperwork and hand over

Day 5 Practical Exercise

Complete a full simulated cash-up using the provided mock till report and cash amounts. Calculate whether the till is balanced, over, or short.

WEEK 2 - Electronic Payments

Day 6: Introduction to EcoCash

What is EcoCash?

EcoCash is Zimbabwe's most widely used mobile money platform, operated by Econet Wireless. It allows customers to send and receive money, pay for goods and services, and transfer funds using their mobile phone.

As a till operator, you must be comfortable processing EcoCash payments every day.

How EcoCash Works for Merchants

Shops that accept EcoCash are registered as merchants. When a customer pays via EcoCash, the money is transferred from the customer's wallet to the shop's merchant wallet instantly.

Processing an EcoCash Payment - Customer Pays via USSD

1. Tell the customer the total amount
2. The customer dials *151# on their phone
3. They select 'Send Money' or 'Pay Merchant'
4. They enter the merchant code / till number
5. They enter the amount and their EcoCash PIN
6. Both you and the customer receive an SMS confirmation
7. You check the confirmation on your till or merchant device
8. Issue the receipt only after confirmation is received

IMPORTANT: NEVER release goods before you receive an SMS or system confirmation. Customers sometimes show fake confirmation messages.

Processing an EcoCash Payment - Merchant-Initiated

1. Enter the sale amount into the till
2. Select EcoCash as the payment method
3. Enter the customer's EcoCash number (phone number)
4. The system sends a push notification to the customer's phone
5. Customer enters their PIN to approve
6. Confirmation appears on the till
7. Issue receipt

Day 6 Practical Exercise

Role-play with your trainer: one person acts as the customer, one as the till operator. Process 5 EcoCash transactions using different amounts.

Day 7: EcoCash Problems and Solutions

Common EcoCash Issues

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
Transaction failed	No network, wrong PIN, insufficient funds	Ask customer to try again or use another payment method
No confirmation received	Network delay	Wait 2 minutes, check merchant portal before retrying
Customer says they paid but no confirmation	Possible fraud attempt	Do NOT release goods. Call supervisor immediately
Wrong amount sent	Customer entered wrong amount	Contact EcoCash support, do not process manually

EcoCash Merchant Portal

Your shop will have access to the EcoCash merchant portal — an online system that shows all transactions. When in doubt about whether a payment went through, check the portal before proceeding.

EcoCash Reversal

If a wrong amount was charged or a transaction was duplicated, a reversal (refund) can be processed. This must always go through your supervisor and be logged in writing.

Day 8: Bank Transfers (ZiMSwitch / ZIPIT)

What is ZIPIT?

ZIPIT (Zimbabwe Interbank Payment Interface Technology) is a bank-to-bank transfer system in Zimbabwe. Customers can transfer money directly from their bank account to the shop's bank account using their mobile banking app or internet banking.

Other Bank Transfer Methods

- ZiMSwitch - connects all Zimbabwean banks for transfers
- Internet banking transfers (FBC, CBZ, Stanbic, NMB, etc.)
- Mobile banking apps (FBC Touch, CBZ Touch, etc.)

Processing a Bank Transfer Payment

1. Tell the customer the total amount
2. Provide the shop's bank account number and bank name
3. Customer makes the transfer using their banking app
4. Customer shows you the transfer confirmation (reference number)
5. Verify the transfer on the shop's bank statement or POS system
6. Record the reference number on the receipt or till system
7. Release goods only after verification

What Details to Give the Customer

Detail	Example
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Bank Name	CBZ Bank / FBC Bank / Stanbic
Account Name	NtandoMods (Pvt) Ltd
Account Number	Provided by your manager
Reference	Customer's name or invoice number

Day 8 Practical Exercise

Write out the bank transfer details your shop would give a customer. Practise explaining the process to a customer in a role-play exercise.

Day 9: Card Swipe (POS Machine)

What is a POS Machine?

A POS (Point of Sale) machine is a card payment terminal that allows customers to pay using their debit or credit card. Cards used include Visa, Mastercard, and ZiMSwitch cards issued by Zimbabwean banks.

Types of Card Payments

- Swipe - customer swipes the magnetic strip on the card reader
- Chip & PIN - customer inserts the chip end of the card and enters their PIN
- Tap / Contactless - customer taps their card on the terminal (where available)

Processing a Card Payment - Step by Step

1. Enter the total amount into the POS machine
2. Turn the terminal to face the customer
3. Ask the customer to insert, swipe, or tap their card
4. Customer enters their PIN (for chip & PIN)
5. Wait for the APPROVED message on the terminal
6. Tear off the merchant copy and the customer copy of the receipt
7. Give the customer their copy and ask them to sign the merchant copy if required

8. File the merchant copy in the daily receipt folder

Card Declined - What to Do

- Tell the customer politely: 'Your card has been declined. Would you like to try another payment method?'
- Do NOT tell the customer why it was declined — you may not know the reason
- Offer EcoCash, cash, or bank transfer as alternatives
- If the machine shows an error code, note it and report to your supervisor

POS Machine Security Rules

- Never let a customer take the POS machine out of your sight
- Never write down a customer's card number
- Never process a transaction you did not initiate on the machine
- Always shield the PIN pad when a customer is entering their PIN
- Report any suspicious behaviour to your supervisor immediately

Day 9 Practical Exercise

Using the training POS terminal provided, process 5 simulated card transactions. Include at least one declined card scenario.

Day 10: Full Assessment and Certification

What Today Covers

Today is your final assessment day. You will be tested on everything covered in the past two weeks. The assessment has three parts: written theory, a practical till simulation, and a cash-up exercise.

Assessment Overview

Assessment Part	What is Tested	Marks
Part 1: Written Theory	Cash handling, EcoCash, bank	40 marks

	transfers, card swipe (20 questions)	
Part 2: Practical Simulation	Process 10 transactions using all 4 payment methods	40 marks
Part 3: Cash-Up Exercise	Count float, reconcile end-of-day cash against till report	20 marks
TOTAL		100 marks

Pass Mark

You need 60% (60 marks out of 100) to pass and receive your NtandoMods Certificate of Competency in Till Operating.

After the Assessment

- Results will be given within 2 working days
- Certificates will be issued within 5 working days of passing
- Students who do not pass may resit once at no extra charge

Quick Reference Guide

Keep this section handy when you start working at a till.

Payment Method Summary

Payment Type	Key Step	Release Goods When
Cash	Count change carefully, cash on top of drawer until change given	Change handed over
EcoCash	Wait for SMS or system confirmation	Confirmed on merchant system
Bank Transfer	Verify reference number on bank system	Transfer confirmed in bank account
Card Swipe	Wait for APPROVED on POS terminal	POS shows APPROVED

Golden Rules for Every Till Operator

1. Never release goods until payment is fully confirmed
2. Always give a receipt
3. Count cash three times — once before, once after, once when giving change
4. Report all discrepancies immediately, no matter how small
5. Never leave the till unattended
6. Treat every customer with respect, even difficult ones
7. If in doubt, call your supervisor — never guess

Contact and Support

Trainer: _____

Supervisor: _____

EcoCash Merchant Support: 114

NtandoMods Contact: ntandomods@gmail.com